USER GUIDE · 1.0.4

Tickertwister Desktop

Understand the business. Then assess the price.



Your personal notebook for financial screening.

Mac · local research dossiers · 39 analysis criteria · optional AI

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01 / YOUR ROUTE THROUGH THE APP

From question to research

A considered workflow, guided by your own judgement.

1. Understand	Enter a ticker. Read what the company does and check the source, currencies, fiscal years and data coverage.
2. Investigate	Examine quality, cash flow and debt. Open the sections that help answer your research question.
3. Value	Explore a range of assumptions in the FCFE model and valuation lab. A model result is not a recommendation to buy.
4. Record	Add the analysis to your research dossier. Write down your thesis, risks and the evidence that would change your mind.
5. Explore	Compare companies if useful, generate a local interpretation, or deliberately request a paid AI analysis.

In this guide

03 Installation and getting started · 04 Valuation and currencies · 05 Quality and history · 06 Your research dossier · 07 AI interpretation · 08 Accounts and saving · 09 Reports and practical help

An initial screen, not a final verdict

The app organises financial data and makes assumptions visible. A high score does not prove a durable competitive advantage or guarantee a safe investment. Investigate important findings in the company's annual reports.

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02 / INSTALLATION AND GETTING STARTED

Your first analysis

For an Apple Silicon Mac running macOS 14 or later.

Install the complete app

Open the DMG and drag **Tickertwister Desktop.app** into **Applications**. Launch the app from Applications, then eject the disk image. The Documentation folder (labelled Documentatie) contains the user guides, licence and source code.

For official releases, choose the DMG marked notarized. Before publication, this package must be Developer ID signed, accepted by Apple and supplied with notarization tickets. Verify its origin and checksum. A normal first-open confirmation may still appear. Older releases and local builds may be unnotarized; do not disable general system security.

Choose your company

Use a Yahoo ticker such as AAPL, MSFT, SONY or ASML.AS. Click **Analyse company**. An internet connection is needed for fresh market data; a saved analysis can be opened without fetching Yahoo data again.

Make the workspace yours

Choose Dutch, English, French, German, Spanish, Italian or Portuguese in the header. The gear menu offers English financial terminology. Numbers and dates follow the locale; currency and values never change. Modern, Professional, dark **Futuristic** and **Atelier** change the colours and typography. Atelier combines parchment, burgundy and copper. Every theme includes a subtle background watermark.

Find your way around

The **magnifying glass** or **Command-F** searches collapsed sections too. Enter moves to the next match. The compact header stays visible; hover over an icon for its function. Section links open the relevant part. **Expand all** opens or closes the details; **New analysis** returns to the start screen.

Check your version

The app footer displays v1.0.4. You can also check Tickertwister Desktop > About Tickertwister Desktop. Save your dossier changes and quit the app before installing an update.

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03 / MODELS AND CURRENCIES

Value rests on assumptions

See how growth, interest rate and cash flow affect the result.

Start with the FCFE multiple model

The basis is **FCFE = operating cash flow - capital expenditure + net borrowing**. The model discounts ten years of cash flows and adds a terminal value. Starting assumptions are a 12% interest rate, a 15× multiple and historical FCFE CAGR from the valuation lab over the full available annual history, without a cap. If CAGR is unavailable, 0% is an editable assumption. Saved analyses retain their settings; Restore defaults adopts the new starting growth. Input arrows adjust model values in steps of 0.1.

Interest rate = discount rate = required return. The margin of safety is 1 - share price / model value. A negative margin means the price exceeds this model result; it does not mean the app has made a sell decision.

When net borrowing is unavailable, the app starts with **FCF (CFO - capex)** as a proxy, assuming zero net borrowing. This is explicitly labelled beside the model; source figures and the quality score remain unchanged.

Consider several outcomes

The valuation lab shows scenarios and the growth that would justify the share price under your assumptions. The sensitivity matrix below the main model changes growth and interest rate. DCF uses perpetual growth for terminal value; Gordon Growth uses dividends and requires a discount rate above the growth rate.

When the share price and accounts use different currencies

Model value and financial history remain in the reporting currency. For SONY, the app uses the confirmed ratio of one ADR to one ordinary share and a retrieved USD/JPY rate. It shows the converted share price, equivalent model value in USD and reference date.

A visible boundary

If FX data is missing or too old, or the share ratio is unconfirmed, the automatic margin remains blank. Other foreign listings do not automatically inherit SONY's ratio. Refresh old analyses to obtain the new data. FX is a snapshot, not a restatement of historical accounts.

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04 / QUALITY AND FINANCIAL HISTORY

Look behind the score

The score helps frame questions. The underlying figures provide context.

39 criteria with visible scoring

Open Score criteria to see each formula, result and annual values. A criterion may contain several base and trend rules. Missing criteria are not scored as zero; they are excluded from the available scoring weight. Always consider data coverage alongside the score.

Adjust the weights

Open **My weighting**. Use the search field and compact editor to find a criterion. A factor of 1 retains the original weight, 2 doubles its importance and 0 excludes it. The scoring rules within each criterion stay the same. Restore original weighting resets the factors.

Your personal score

The prominent score uses your active weights; the standard score remains visible as a reference. A saved dossier entry retains its own weighting. AI uses the score and weights of the selected dossier company; for the currently open analysis, its current weights are used.

Most recent figures first

Tables place the most recent period on the left. Score criteria and historical series appear in two compact columns; an expanded item takes the full width. A dash means missing or unusable data, not zero. Annual tables choose a common unit based on typical amounts, such as millions for smaller companies. Always read the unit above the table. Charts run chronologically from oldest to newest.

Quality checks and annual reports

Orange means investigate, green means no signal under that rule, and grey means not assessable. These are rules of thumb, not sector-specific standards. Banks, insurers, exceptional profits and major acquisitions need additional interpretation.

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05 / FROM ANALYSIS TO CONVICTION

Your private research dossier

A separate workspace, with no model analysis underneath.

Open, close and return

Click **My research dossier**. **Close research dossier** returns to the analysis. **New analysis** closes the dossier view and opens the start screen. Your dossier stays loaded; save your changes before quitting the app.

My companies	Choose Cards or List and collapse the collection when you do not need it. Click a company name to select its notes. With no comparison boxes checked, the active company is used for interpretation. Check one to four companies to select them explicitly.
My investment thesis	Four resizable text fields appear in two columns. Record your arguments, risks, counter-evidence and next question. The review date can include an optional hour and minute. Status colours: grey Researching, orange Watch, red Too hard and green Investment candidate.
Financial research data	Select an available common period or maximum history. The app states the actual dates and method. Long-term comparisons can use fiscal year-ends up to 190 days apart; check the context.
Interpretation	Local interpretation and paid AI controls appear below the financial data. Each can be opened or closed independently. The AI result appears across the full width.

Removing a company: click its cross and confirm. This also removes its notes from the current list. The change becomes permanent when you save changes; until then you can undo it. The separate AI archive and standalone analysis files are retained.

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06 / INTERPRETATION AND CONCLUSION

AI by deliberate choice

The local summary is free. An API request is a separate, paid action.

Analysis profile	Luna is the default for lower-cost screening. Sol and Astra offer more demanding analysis profiles at higher cost. There is no automatic model switch or paid retry.
Reasoning effort	Choose Low, Medium or High. Medium is the starting setting. Higher effort can require more tokens and time.
Token limit	8192 is the default limit for reasoning and the answer combined. The requested report remains around 350-500 words in seven sections. The limit does not guarantee a complete answer.
Output language	AI initially follows the app language. Select any of the seven languages independently if preferred. The choice is remembered. Existing results remain available in their original language; a requested API translation is a separate paid action.

Review, consent and request

Open the Disclaimer and, if useful, inspect the exact financial input. Tick consent to transmission and costs, then click **Generate AI interpretation and conclusion**. Opening the panel alone costs nothing. Enter your key in the secure Mac dialog.

Input includes financial data, criteria, weights and quality scores. Your own valuation assumptions and personal notes are not sent. The result and its financial input are automatically archived locally, independently of manually saving your thesis.

Treat the opinion as research, not fact

Check AI statements against source documents. Reject, wait, too hard and investment candidate are conclusions for further screening, not guarantees or personal investment advice. API translation is optional, paid and preserves the original.

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07 / ACCOUNTS AND DATA

Work privately and save

Local accounts separate dossiers. Reliable backups still matter.

Your own account

Click Account and create a username and password. Each new account starts with an empty dossier; the first account can optionally import the existing dossier. This local version has no cloud registration, email verification or two-factor sign-in.

Use a password manager. There is **no password recovery**. Sign in again after quitting. Use Lock / switch user before someone else uses the Mac; there is no automatic inactivity lock.

Remember your API key

With a local account, you can select Save in macOS Keychain in the native key dialog. The key is additionally encrypted with your profile vault. Otherwise it remains only in native memory for the session. Forget API key removes it from memory and Keychain.

Three different ways to save

Save analysis	A standalone .tickertwister file containing the figures and model assumptions. Open analysis restores this snapshot without fetching Yahoo data again.
Save changes	Writes your dossier and personal notes to disk. A save button also appears near the text fields. An unsaved company removal can still be undone.
AI archive	Saved automatically. Analyses remain available for the relevant company and for selective printing.

With an account, the internal dossier and AI archive are encrypted. Standalone exports, PDFs, general market cache and old backups are not covered by that encryption. Back up ~/Library/Application Support/Tickertwister/Profiles and keep your password separately. No independent security audit has been performed.

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08 / PRINTING AND PRACTICAL HELP

From workspace to report

Choose the report that supports your next research step.

Company report

Click Print report in the model analysis. This report includes the company description, quality score, FCFE valuation, key ratios, charts, checks and available notes. The additional DCF sandbox is not a fixed report section.

Research dossier

Print the active company or checked companies from the dossier. Selected companies are printed; with no checkboxes selected, the active company is used. Current notes are included even before saving. Under Saved AI analyses, select the AI texts to append. Without a selection, no AI appendices are printed.

Missing data or something not working?

No fresh data	Check the ticker and internet connection. Yahoo may limit requests; try again later. A saved analysis does not refresh itself.
Blank margin or dividend	Check currencies, share basis and source data. Missing values are not invented. Different currencies require confirmed FX and share data. The explicitly labelled FCF proxy is a model assumption, not a replacement source figure.
Incomplete AI answer	API costs may already have been incurred. There is no automatic retry. Check the settings and increase the token limit only if you choose to request again.

Sources, rights and limits

Financial data: Yahoo Finance via yfinance 1.8.0. Calculation rules: Tickertwister / FinAnalysis, inspired by the work of Mary Buffett and David Clark. App code is supplied under AGPLv3; see LICENSE and NOTICE for the precise terms and third-party components. Data licences are separate from the code licence. The illustration was generated for this project.

Sony ADR ratio: official Sony announcement filed with the SEC, 14 May 2024. The app retains the source with the share basis. AI pricing: developers.openai.com/api/docs/pricing. Translation review by native financial specialists is pending. Documentation reviewed: 9 November 2026.

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